SYSTEMS THEORY

The systems theory originated primarily due to the behavioural revolution in social science. The desire of the new genre of social scientists, to evolve a general body of knowledge by integrating the various disciplines of social sciences, finally led to the emergence of a host of theoretical approaches inspired by natural science methods. The chief among them was the systems analysis, and prominent contributions in the field of international politics were made by Easton (1965), Kaplan (1957), McClelland (1966), Rosenau (1961), and Boulding (1956), among others.

Morton Kaplan[27] has been the chief exponent of systems theory in international relations. He conceives international system as an analytical entity for explaining the behaviour of international actors and the regulative, integrative and disintegrative consequences of their policies. The positive element in Kaplan's thinking is the consideration of the possibility of 'change'. Thus he studied the behaviour of a system under changing conditions. He stated that there is some coherence, regularity and order in international relations and it is constituted of two things: "international system" and "nation-state system". The international system is composed of subsystems and a set of actors, both international and supranational, and is characterized by interactions among them. Nation-states are the primary actors and their role changes with the change in the international system. Kaplan describes six models of international system. They are:

1. The Balance of Power System
2. The Loose Bipolar System
3. The Tight Bipolar System
4. The Universal System
5. The Hierarchical System
6. The Unit Veto System.

The Balance of Power System: According to Kaplan, the period between 1815 and 1914 experienced a golden age of Balance of Power (BOP). Since the beginning of the twentieth century, the